

Topological Systems with CP2K

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Abstract

Electronic transport and topology probe information that cannot be inferred from band energies alone. Current operators, inter-state overlaps, symmetry representations, and the spatial structure of a Hamiltonian must be treated consistently. We formulate these quantities in the nonorthogonal Gaussian atomic-orbital representation of CP2K, connecting finite-temperature Kubo transport, Wilson-loop and Chern analysis, crystalline symmetry representations, spectral localizers, and the quadratic pseudospectrum. The overlap metric is retained in operator products, symmetry transformations, and spectral-gap estimates. Real-space and reciprocal-space constructions share Hamiltonian, position, and spin-orbit matrix elements without requiring a fitted Wannier Hamiltonian. Dense reference calculations are complemented by distributed sparse assembly, symmetric-indefinite inertia calculations, and an optional sparse Pfaffian back-end. We explain how the finite matrix formulations relate to noncommutative geometry and distinguish local topological protection from an electronic band gap or a mobility gap. Wilson and inversion calculations, native projective little-group and antiunitary corepresentation tests, and serial/MPI operator comparisons provide complementary validation. The implementation scope is stated explicitly: the current Kubo path evaluates symmetric dissipative DC response. Crystalline analysis includes nonsymmorphic endpoint-to-line compatibility, but a complete space-group EBR classifier and universal symmetry reduction of topological properties remain development targets.

Keywords: CP2K, Kubo transport, noncommutative geometry, spectral localizer, topological quantum chemistry, spin-orbit coupling

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1 Introduction

Electronic-structure theory supplies a Hamiltonian and a Hilbert-space representation; extracting transport or topological information requires additional structure. Two calculations can agree in their eigenvalues while disagreeing in matrix elements of position, current, or a symmetry operator. This distinction is especially important in a localized nonorthogonal basis, where ordinary matrix multiplication is not the representation of operator composition.

The QUICKSTEP module of CP2K combines localized Gaussian orbitals with plane-wave and multigrid representations of densities and electrostatics [1, 2, 3, 4]. This representation provides access to spatially resolved operators without first fitting a tight-binding Hamiltonian. It also creates specific obligations: the AO metric, periodic image indices, Bloch convention, nonlocal pseudopotentials, and spinor ordering must remain consistent across every analysis.

The first-principles transport programme of Kühne, Heske and Prodan [5] supplies an important starting point: thermally disordered structures are treated as configurations of a covariant family of Hamiltonians, and dissipation is included in the finite-temperature response. Bellissard’s operator-algebraic framework connects this viewpoint to topology without assuming exact translation symmetry of each configuration [6, 7]. The present manuscript combines this motivation with reciprocal-space invariants and spatially resolved finite-matrix diagnostics.

The scope is deliberately broader than a band-topology interface. Wilson loops resolve the geometry of an isolated band subspace; crystalline representations resolve symmetry constraints; a localizer tests an energy-position query; a quadratic pseudospectrum produces approximately localized states; and Kubo response determines a transport coefficient at specified temperature and dissipation. None of these outputs can simply be substituted for another.

The companion study on symmetry-reduced k-point sampling and Wannier analysis develops the underlying Bloch reconstruction and full-mesh export. We repeat the operator conventions needed to make the present article self-contained, but keep the detailed topology, transport, and localizer analysis here. In particular, Wannier90 is an optional route to a reduced representation, not a prerequisite for native AO analysis. Sections below distinguish implemented algorithms from the more general theory and from extensions still requiring validation. The materials-discovery applications discussed later are distinguished from our small test and demonstration calculations: the former motivate the scientific use of these methods, while the latter establish specific numerical identities and illustrate their operation.

2 Hamiltonians and operators in a nonorthogonal basis

2.1 Covariant matrices and the physical metric

Let Φ denote the row of basis functions $|\phi_\mu\rangle$, and $|\psi\rangle = \Phi c$. Define

$$S = \Phi^\dagger \Phi, \quad H = \Phi^\dagger \hat{H} \Phi, \quad X_a = \Phi^\dagger \hat{r}_a \Phi. \quad (2.1)$$

The overlap must be positive definite on the retained basis, and the normalization is $c^\dagger S c = 1$. The generalized eigenproblem is

$$H C = S C \varepsilon, \quad C^\dagger S C = I. \quad (2.2)$$

A covariant matrix A acts on coefficient vectors through $S^{-1} A$. Consequently, composition of two *projected* operators is represented by $A S^{-1} B$, and the projected commutator by $A S^{-1} B - B S^{-1} A$. An ordinary product AB is generally incorrect.

For a nonsingular change of basis $\Phi' = \Phi T$,

$$S' = T^\dagger S T, \quad A' = T^\dagger A T, \quad c' = T^{-1} c. \quad (2.3)$$

The expectation $c^\dagger A c$ and the generalized spectrum are unchanged. The orthonormal representation $\tilde{A} = S^{-1/2} A S^{-1/2}$ is useful for proofs and dense reference calculations. It need not be formed in a sparse implementation: products can be evaluated by solving linear systems with S .

A finite-basis projection is not an algebra homomorphism for arbitrary continuum operators. With $\Pi = \Phi S^{-1} \Phi^\dagger$, $\Phi^\dagger \hat{A} \Pi \hat{B} \Phi$ differs in general from $\Phi^\dagger \hat{A} \hat{B} \Phi$. Thus a commutator or a variance of projected positions is an observable of the projected model, not automatically its complete-basis continuum counterpart. This distinction is monitored through basis convergence rather than hidden in a numerical tolerance.

2.2 Finite positions and AO export

For an isolated system, analytic Gaussian first moments provide X_a in the same basis ordering as H and S . Translation of the coordinate origin by x_a gives $X_a - x_a S$, not $X_a - x_a I$. Likewise an energy query uses $H - E S$. These two simple identities are essential for origin and energy-shift invariance.

The `AO_MATRICES` print section can export overlap, scalar KS Hamiltonian, and the three position matrices. They permit an independent finite-Hamiltonian calculation. Activating SOC in a property section does not silently turn the separate scalar KS export into a spinor Hamiltonian export. Model Hamiltonians can use the low-level matrix kernels when the metric, positions, and symmetry structure are supplied consistently; this does not imply automatic adapters for every electronic-structure method.

2.3 Bloch operators and directed overlaps

In the cell Fourier convention,

$$H_{\mu\nu}(\mathbf{k}) = \sum_{\mathbf{R}} e^{i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{R}} H_{\mu\nu}(\mathbf{R}), \quad S_{\mu\nu}(\mathbf{k}) = \sum_{\mathbf{R}} e^{i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{R}} S_{\mu\nu}(\mathbf{R}). \quad (2.4)$$

Here $\mathbf{k}$ is Cartesian and includes inverse-length units; fractional reciprocal coordinates instead require 2π in the phase. Image-cell labels cannot be discarded before forming derivatives or inter-k-point connections.

For cell-periodic states and a directed step $\mathbf{b}$, the occupied-state overlap is

$$M(\mathbf{k}, \mathbf{b}) = C^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) O(\mathbf{k} + \mathbf{b}; \mathbf{b}) C(\mathbf{k} + \mathbf{b}), \quad O_{\mu\nu} = \sum_{\mathbf{R}} e^{i(\mathbf{k}+\mathbf{b})\cdot\mathbf{R}} \langle \phi_{\mu 0} | e^{-i\mathbf{b}\cdot\mathbf{r}} | \phi_{\nu \mathbf{R}} \rangle. \quad (2.5)$$

The zero-step limit is $S(\mathbf{k})$, but a finite link is not obtained by replacing O with S , or by simply contracting coefficient vectors. Neighbor lists, reciprocal-boundary phases, and the selected band rank are part of the observable. Wannier90's file and library interfaces can consume such data [8]; native Wilson calculations need no Wannier localization or interpolation.

2.4 Spin-orbit coupling and symmetry

The implementations considered here start from a converged scalar restricted SCF potential and add GTH spin-orbit matrix elements. The localizer and Bloch-Kubo paths use the complete AO spinor space, whereas a second-variational band-topology calculation uses a selected scalar-state space whose size must be converged separately. Neither construction is self-consistent noncollinear SOC DFT.

In spin-major ordering, the overlap is $\mathbb{S} = \text{diag}(S, S)$ and physical time reversal is $\Theta = JK$, where

$$J = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & I \\ -I & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \Theta^2 = -I. \quad (2.6)$$

Time-reversal relations must be checked for the Hamiltonian, metric, and relevant operators; the presence of an SOC pseudopotential alone does not establish them. A Cartesian spatial rotation R

acts on spin through an $SU(2)$ lift of $\det(R)R$, with inversion acting trivially on spin and separately on orbital parity. The sign ambiguity of this lift is retained in the double-group multiplication law.

3 Noncommutative geometry and physical interpretation

3.1 Covariance rather than exact order

For a family of configurations $\omega \in \Omega$, a spatial action τ_a is represented by

$$U_a H_\omega U_a^{-1} = H_{\tau_a \omega}. \quad (3.1)$$

This covariance is weaker than $[U_a, H_\omega] = 0$: a displaced thermal configuration need not have the symmetries of its probability measure. Bellissard’s formulation replaces the Brillouin-zone description by an algebra of such covariant observables with a trace per physical volume [6]. The operator-algebraic viewpoint therefore remains meaningful when a single Bloch momentum is not a good quantum number.

For sufficiently local observables, the trace per volume has the schematic realization

$$\mathcal{T}(A) = \lim_{V \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{V} \text{Tr}(\chi_V A \chi_V), \quad (3.2)$$

with the appropriate orbital trace and a physical-volume normalization. Ergodicity supplies the conditions under which a typical large configuration and an ensemble average agree. It does not guarantee that a particular small simulation cell has self-averaged.

The first-principles construction must preserve covariance while passing from continuum KS operators to AO matrices [5]. The metric is part of that transformation. In a finite AO space, traces of projected covariant matrices use $\text{Tr}(S^{-1}A)$; traces of products use the intervening metric factors. For local traces the spatial cutoff itself is an operator, not merely an arbitrary subset of coefficient indices.

3.2 Derivations, Fermi projections, and Chern pairings

Choose spatial derivations $\nabla_a A = -i[X_a, A]$ in an orthonormal representation. For the Fermi projection $P = \mathbf{1}_{(-\infty, E_F)}(H)$, a two-dimensional Chern pairing can be written, with a fixed orientation, as

$$C = 2\pi i \mathcal{T}(P[\nabla_1 P, \nabla_2 P]) = -2\pi i \mathcal{T}(P[[X_1, P], [X_2, P]]). \quad (3.3)$$

The trace normalization and oriented coordinates are chosen so that the periodic limit agrees with the Berry-curvature convention used below. Reversing that orientation reverses C . Index theory relates such pairings to stable integers under the required locality and gap or localization assumptions [7]. Equation (3.3) is a theoretical connection, not a claim that the current implementation evaluates a general thermodynamic-limit noncommutative Chern formula.

A spectral gap excludes eigenvalues in an interval. A mobility gap instead concerns localization and transport even when states are present. A localizer gap is the smallest singular value of a composite energy-position operator. These three gaps answer different questions. The localizer is useful precisely because spatially resolved information can remain available where a bulk band classification is not directly applicable [9]. Its numerical invertibility does not by itself prove a mobility-gap theorem for a DFT material.

3.3 Thermal disorder and convergence

An AIMD trajectory can supply configurations for a disorder average. The nuclear sampling temperature, the electronic Fermi temperature, and the dissipative relaxation scale are conceptually distinct. A calculation should record all three rather than infer them from a single input

temperature. Configuration correlations determine how many effectively independent samples have been obtained; a small standard error computed from strongly correlated snapshots is not a substitute for a correlation analysis.

The thermodynamic limit, zero-temperature limit, and vanishing dissipation limit cannot generally be interchanged. At fixed finite volume the spectrum is discrete, so taking the broadening to zero first can give a qualitatively misleading DC response. For a material prediction we therefore require size and sampling convergence at a specified positive dissipation, followed by a physically justified study of its dependence. The present validation examples establish numerical identities at fixed inputs, not a microscopic scattering model or a disorder-converged transport prediction.

4 Finite-temperature Kubo transport

4.1 Liouvillian formulation and dissipation

Let $f(H) = [1 + \exp((H - \mu)/k_B T)]^{-1}$ and define the energy-valued Liouvillian $\mathcal{L}_H(A) = i[H, A]$. In the relaxation-time approximation, a positive energy broadening Γ replaces a more general dissipative superoperator. With $\nabla_a = -i[X_a, \cdot]$, a convenient conductivity convention is

$$\sigma_{ab} = -\frac{e^2}{\hbar} \mathcal{T} \left[(\nabla_a H) (\Gamma + \mathcal{L}_H)^{-1} \nabla_b f(H) \right]. \quad (4.1)$$

The real symmetric part gives the dissipative DC response considered here. The factor $e > 0$ is the magnitude of the electron charge. This expression states the operator structure behind the finite-volume calculation, including the role of dissipation [5]. A constant Γ is an approximation to scattering; it is not obtained from the SCF convergence tolerance or from a plotted density-of-states width.

Let $a_{nm}^b = \langle n | \nabla_b H | m \rangle = \hbar v_{nm}^b$, and define the nonnegative Fermi divided difference

$$F_{nm} = \begin{cases} -\frac{f(\varepsilon_n) - f(\varepsilon_m)}{\varepsilon_n - \varepsilon_m}, & \varepsilon_n \neq \varepsilon_m, \\ -f'(\varepsilon_n) = \frac{f(\varepsilon_n)[1 - f(\varepsilon_n)]}{k_B T}, & \varepsilon_n = \varepsilon_m. \end{cases} \quad (4.2)$$

A spectral expansion of Eq. (4.1) gives

$$\sigma_{ab}^{\text{diss}} = \frac{e^2}{\hbar V_d} \sum_{\mathbf{k}, s} w_{\mathbf{k}} g_s \sum_{nm} F_{nmks} \frac{\Gamma}{\Gamma^2 + (\varepsilon_{nks} - \varepsilon_{mks})^2} \Re \left[a_{nmks}^a a_{mnks}^b \right]. \quad (4.3)$$

Here $\sum_{\mathbf{k}} w_{\mathbf{k}} = 1$, V_d is the periodic length, area, or volume, and g_s accounts for spin occupancy without double counting. For explicit SOC spinors, each state has unit maximum occupation. The tensor is projected onto the periodic Cartesian subspace before reporting a reduced-dimensional conductivity.

Equation (4.3) is positive semidefinite for $T, \Gamma > 0$. In particular, its diagonal elements are nonnegative. The units are conductance times length^{2-d}: S m in one dimension, S in two dimensions, and S/m in three dimensions, with the latter optionally printed as S/cm. Vacuum padding must not change a two-dimensional sheet conductivity through an arbitrary three-dimensional volume factor. An isolated finite-system response is not automatically a measurable bulk conductivity.

4.2 Degenerate levels and intraband response

The equal-energy branch of Eq. (4.2) applies to all matrix elements within a degenerate subspace, not just $n = m$. In a periodic system, the diagonal band velocity can be nonzero and provides an intraband term proportional to $-f'/\Gamma$. Discarding diagonal terms would remove this contribution. Likewise, dividing current matrix elements by $\varepsilon_n - \varepsilon_m$ cannot be used to define a stable position operator in a degenerate block.

A unitary change of basis inside an exactly degenerate subspace rotates the complete current block. Because the scalar kernel is constant on that block, the summed contraction is unchanged. This is why comparisons should involve block traces or projectors rather than phases of individual eigenvectors. Near equal energies, the implementation evaluates the divided difference with a smooth finite-temperature expansion instead of subtracting nearly identical Fermi functions.

4.3 Three current-operator choices

The historical atom-embedding approximation associates each AO with its nuclear center. It provides an economical representation but does not contain all intra-atomic Gaussian position matrix elements. It remains a distinct, explicitly selected approximation.

For isolated systems, the projected-AO alternative uses

$$J_a = HS^{-1}X_a - X_aS^{-1}H, \quad \hbar v_a = iJ_a. \quad (4.4)$$

J_a is anti-Hermitian. In an S -orthonormal eigenbasis it becomes $(J_a)_{nm} = (\varepsilon_n - \varepsilon_m)(X_a^{\text{MO}})_{nm}$. The complex conjugation in a conductivity contraction must be retained when SOC is present. This construction is exact for the projected finite AO model; the difference between projected and continuum commutators remains a basis-convergence question.

For periodic calculations, a bounded Cartesian position in one simulation cell is not a valid replacement for the periodic current. The Bloch path uses derivatives of the image Hamiltonian and overlap together with analytic first-moment integrals. In atomic units its matrix elements are

$$\begin{aligned} v_{nm}^a(\mathbf{k}) = & [C^\dagger \partial_a H C]_{nm} - \varepsilon_n [C^\dagger \partial_a S C]_{nm} \\ & + i(\varepsilon_n - \varepsilon_m) [C^\dagger D_a C]_{nm}, \end{aligned} \quad (4.5)$$

where ∂_a differentiates Cartesian k_a . The cell-gauge connection obeys

$$D_a - D_a^\dagger = -i \partial_a S. \quad (4.6)$$

These identities make explicit why the derivative of H alone, the canonical momentum, and the full velocity are not interchangeable in a local-orbital calculation [10].

Hermiticity can be checked directly: the anti-Hermitian part from the energy-weighted overlap derivative is cancelled by Eq. (4.6). For $n = m$, Eq. (4.5) reduces to the generalized Hellmann–Feynman derivative $c_n^\dagger (\partial_a H - \varepsilon_n \partial_a S) c_n$. No eigenvector derivative or energy-denominator division is required.

For distinct band energies, the same operator determines the interband position (dipole) matrix elements in atomic units,

$$d_{nm}^a(\mathbf{k}) = -\frac{i v_{nm}^a(\mathbf{k})}{\varepsilon_{n\mathbf{k}} - \varepsilon_{m\mathbf{k}}}, \quad \varepsilon_{n\mathbf{k}} \neq \varepsilon_{m\mathbf{k}}. \quad (4.7)$$

Here d_{nm}^a has units of length and does not include the electron charge. Substitution of Eq. (4.5) gives the Hamiltonian-derivative term, the energy-weighted overlap-derivative term, and $[C^\dagger D_a C]_{nm}$. All three are required in a general nonorthogonal local-orbital basis [10]. The $\mathbf{k}$ -point moment calculation constructs these matrices from real-space image-cell integrals and can use the SCF mesh, a separate KPOINTS set, or a KPOINT_SET path in the moments print section. Equation (4.7) is only an interband relation. It neither supplies diagonal positions in a periodic system nor replaces the undivided velocity blocks needed for degenerate and intraband transport.

4.4 Gauge covariance and nonlocal operators

Under a differentiable, nonsingular AO basis change $T(\mathbf{k})$, $H' = T^\dagger H T$, $S' = T^\dagger S T$, and $C' = T^{-1} C$. The connection must transform as

$$D'_a = T^\dagger D_a T - i(\partial_a T)^\dagger S T. \quad (4.8)$$

Substitution into Eq. (4.5) cancels all derivatives of T by using $HC = SC\varepsilon$. The physical velocity is therefore unchanged even under a k -dependent nonunitary AO transformation. This is a stronger test than comparing band energies.

The Hamiltonian derivatives include all retained image contributions, including nonlocal pseudopotential and GTH-SOC terms. The connection term is still required; including a derivative of the SOC Hamiltonian does not make the bare Peierls derivative complete. SCF-potential convergence, scalar or spinor basis convergence, and analysis-mesh convergence must be checked independently.

4.5 Property symmetry and practical scope

The optional Bloch-Kubo symmetry path diagonalizes only representatives of its own analysis mesh. Atom permutations, AO rotations, lattice-image phases, physical spin rotations, and antiunitary conjugation reconstruct the remaining eigenframes. Each candidate frame is tested through $C^\dagger SC = I$, $C^\dagger HC = \varepsilon$, and target/source current covariance. An unacceptable map is not silently inserted into the conductivity.

For a spatial Cartesian operation R , velocities rotate as a polar vector. Time reversal adds the reversal of velocity as well as complex conjugation. In the anti-Hermitian current convention used internally, the extra factor of i must also be conjugated. The response sums the full tensor over the full mesh; it is not an irreducible scalar-weight substitution for anisotropic currents.

The current implementation provides symmetric dissipative DC conductivity with a prescribed relaxation scale. It does not yet provide anomalous Hall, spin Hall, a general frequency-dependent response, or microscopic scattering superoperators. Its Bloch matrices and eigenframes are a bounded dense reference path, although eigensystems are distributed over MPI ranks. Fewer diagonalizations do not imply proportional memory or runtime savings when target operators are still explicitly evaluated.

5 Band topology: Wilson loops, Chern numbers, and time reversal

The overlap matrices used for Wannier construction also contain the geometry of an isolated band subspace. Following established hybrid-Wannier and Wilson-loop formulations [11, 12], the native analysis in CP2K evaluates Berry phases, hybrid Wannier charge centers, the $\mathbb{Z}_2$ invariant of a time-reversal-invariant plane, and the first Chern number C_1 . The native analysis evaluates Wilson loops and topological invariants directly from Gaussian-basis Bloch-state overlaps, without requiring Z2Pack or a maximally localized Wannier representation. Z2Pack remains an optional external analysis route and a complementary validation tool. Its adapter supplies the same first-principles overlaps to an external implementation with its own line and surface sampling. Neither route requires a fitted tight-binding Hamiltonian.

5.1 Interband geometry and Berry curvature

The velocity and dipole matrix elements in Eqs. (4.5) and (4.7) also connect the local-orbital representation to band geometry. For a nondegenerate band, the moment implementation evaluates the interband expression

$$\begin{aligned}\Omega_n^\gamma(\mathbf{k}) &= 2 \operatorname{Im} \sum_{m \neq n} d_{nm}^\alpha(\mathbf{k}) d_{mn}^\beta(\mathbf{k}) \\ &= 2 \operatorname{Im} \sum_{m \neq n} \frac{v_{nm}^\alpha(\mathbf{k}) v_{mn}^\beta(\mathbf{k})}{(\varepsilon_{n\mathbf{k}} - \varepsilon_{m\mathbf{k}})^2},\end{aligned}\tag{5.1}$$

where (α, β, γ) is a cyclic permutation of (x, y, z) . This equation uses the sign convention of the moment output. Comparisons with overlap-based phases require matching the phase and

surface-orientation conventions. With Cartesian reciprocal coordinates, Ω_n^γ has units of length squared. The formula reveals why small avoided crossings can produce sharply localized curvature and why band-energy convergence alone does not establish convergence of this observable. The band sum, AO basis, and reciprocal-space sampling require separate convergence checks.

The product in Eq. (5.1) is invariant under independent phase changes of nondegenerate eigenstates. At an exact degeneracy, however, the individual-band assignment is not invariant under rotations within the degenerate subspace, and division by the vanishing energy difference is not defined. An isolated group of bands must instead be treated through its projector or matrix-valued connection. The Wilson construction below implements this subspace viewpoint without resolving arbitrary eigenvectors within the group. The interband expression describes the implemented finite-basis moment representation and is not by itself a proof of complete-basis curvature or an integer Chern number. Nor does this geometric quantity constitute an implementation of anomalous Hall transport, which is distinct from the dissipative response in Section 4.

5.2 Directed overlaps and Wilson loops

Consider a closed directed path $\mathbf{k}_0, \dots, \mathbf{k}_L$ with $\mathbf{k}_L = \mathbf{k}_0 + \mathbf{G}$ and links $\mathbf{b}_j = \mathbf{k}_{j+1} - \mathbf{k}_j$. For N_{occ} occupied states, each link is the square matrix in Eq. (2.5). In the Gaussian representation, its AO operator is explicitly

$$O_{\mu\nu}(\mathbf{k} + \mathbf{b}; \mathbf{b}) = \sum_{\mathbf{R}} e^{i(\mathbf{k}+\mathbf{b})\cdot\mathbf{R}} \langle \phi_{\mu\mathbf{0}} | e^{-i\mathbf{b}\cdot\mathbf{r}} | \phi_{\nu\mathbf{R}} \rangle. \quad (5.2)$$

Here $\phi_{\mu\mathbf{R}}(\mathbf{r}) = \phi_{\mu}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{R})$ denotes an individual localized orbital, not a Bloch sum. The zero-step limit recovers $S(\mathbf{k})$. At finite displacement, however, this is a directed cross-k operator, not a Hermitian matrix at one k-point. Its construction retains ordered atom pairs, image-cell phases, and the same periodic atomic images as the Hamiltonian. Consequently, neither $C^\dagger(\mathbf{k})C(\mathbf{k} + \mathbf{b})$ nor replacement of the operator by $S(\mathbf{k})$ represents the required overlap. Reciprocal-boundary links retain their integer $\mathbf{G}$ shift, implementing $u_{n,\mathbf{k}+\mathbf{G}}(\mathbf{r}) = e^{-i\mathbf{G}\cdot\mathbf{r}} u_{n\mathbf{k}}(\mathbf{r})$ in a consistent boundary gauge.

At finite sampling the occupied-subspace overlap need not be unitary. Each link is factorized and replaced by its unitary polar factor,

$$M_j = U_j \Sigma_j V_j^\dagger, \quad Q_j = U_j V_j^\dagger, \quad \mathcal{W} = Q_0 Q_1 \cdots Q_{L-1}. \quad (5.3)$$

The smallest singular value of M_j diagnoses loss of continuity or an inadequately resolved subspace. A rank-deficient link is rejected. For a unitary change of occupied-band basis $C_j \mapsto C_j G_j$, the link and closed product transform as

$$Q_j \mapsto G_j^\dagger Q_j G_{j+1}, \quad \mathcal{W} \mapsto G_0^\dagger \mathcal{W} G_0. \quad (5.4)$$

Thus the Wilson spectrum is gauge invariant although individual overlaps are not. With the path and phase convention used here,

$$\lambda_n(\mathcal{W}) = e^{2\pi i \bar{x}_n}, \quad \bar{x}_n = \frac{\arg \lambda_n}{2\pi} \pmod{1}, \quad \gamma = \arg \det \mathcal{W}. \quad (5.5)$$

The $\bar{x}_n$ are the hybrid Wannier charge centers in reduced units, and γ is the total loop phase in this convention. Reversing the loop reverses the eigenphases. The absolute center origin follows the atomic and cell-origin convention, whereas the topological classification does not.

For spinful time-reversal symmetry, loops spanning half a reciprocal plane connect two time-reversal-invariant boundaries. The parity of partner exchange in the center spectrum determines the two-dimensional invariant. The largest-gap construction tracks the center z_ℓ of the largest

gap between adjacent centers on each sampled loop and counts crossings between successive loops [11, 12], giving

$$\nu = N_{\text{cross}} \pmod{2}. \quad (5.6)$$

Loop resolution and transverse sampling are refined together. Acceptance uses center displacements, neighboring-loop gap separation, boundary Kramers pairing, and stable parity. The occupied rank is fixed and separated from conduction states throughout the sampled surface.

On a closed full reciprocal-space surface, C_1 is obtained instead from the winding of the determinant Wilson phase. With $\gamma_\ell = \arg \det \mathcal{W}_\ell$ and a periodic transverse index, the discrete estimate in the present orientation convention is

$$C_1^{\text{mesh}} = \frac{1}{2\pi} \sum_\ell \text{Arg} \exp[i(\gamma_{\ell+1} - \gamma_\ell)]. \quad (5.7)$$

The phase increments must be resolved under refinement, and the final transverse boundary must be sewn to the initial one. Unlike the time-reversal half-plane construction, this calculation covers a full closed surface and does not require time-reversal symmetry. The native implementation checks closure and stable winding under refinement and retains the unrounded winding alongside the integer candidate.

In CP2K, explicit fractional k-points and directed connections are read from a `.nnkp` file with `KPOINTS_SOURCE NNKP`, or generated internally with `KPOINTS_SOURCE WILSON`. `WILSON_LOOP` evaluates a loop, `Z2` selects the half-plane analysis, and `CHERN` selects the full-surface C_1 analysis. The converged SCF potential is held fixed while the post-SCF points are diagonalized. The integration mesh defining the density and the ordered paths probing its band topology are distinct objects. Spin-orbit coupling (SOC) enters through a second-variational spinor Hamiltonian built from the scalar states and pseudopotential SOC matrix elements. For spinor coefficients the link is

$$M_j = C_{j,\uparrow}^\dagger O_j C_{j+1,\uparrow} + C_{j,\downarrow}^\dagger O_j C_{j+1,\downarrow}, \quad (5.8)$$

and band selection refers to this spinor spectrum.

This application makes the role of symmetry particularly clear. Scalar irreducible-mesh weights cannot replace an ordered Wilson product. A path requires explicit states at its points or their symmetry reconstruction with all orbital rotations, spin transformations, and boundary phases. The native explicit-path calculation obtains these states by diagonalizing the fixed-potential problem at the requested points. It therefore complements symmetry-reduced SCF quadrature while retaining the complete neighbor connectivity needed for a gauge-covariant observable.

Figure 1 demonstrates the calculation using small test systems: a periodic neon reference and buckled stanene, a representative quantum spin Hall system [13]. The computed invariants are $\nu = 0$ and $\nu = 1$, respectively. The sampling-converged stanene surface contains 193 loops with 192 points per loop. Native and Z2Pack analysis of the same polar-unitarized overlaps agree in the Wilson eigenvalues to 8×10^{-14} . A separately adaptive Z2Pack-driven calculation also yields $\nu = 1$. Operator-level checks independently test the zero-step metric, reverse-link adjoint identity, and displaced atomic centers. These complementary tests connect the local Gaussian integral representation to the global topology of the occupied bands. Inputs, sampling parameters, and figure data are given in the Supporting Information and accompanying calculation records.

6 Crystalline representations and topological quantum chemistry

6.1 Implemented inversion analysis

An independently versioned native extension evaluates inversion representations at time-reversal-invariant momenta (TRIM). This analysis requires spatial inversion of the crystal, unlike the time-reversal pairing used to reduce a scalar SCF mesh. The TRIM are diagonalized at the converged SCF potential independently of the integration mesh, without a Wannier90 execution

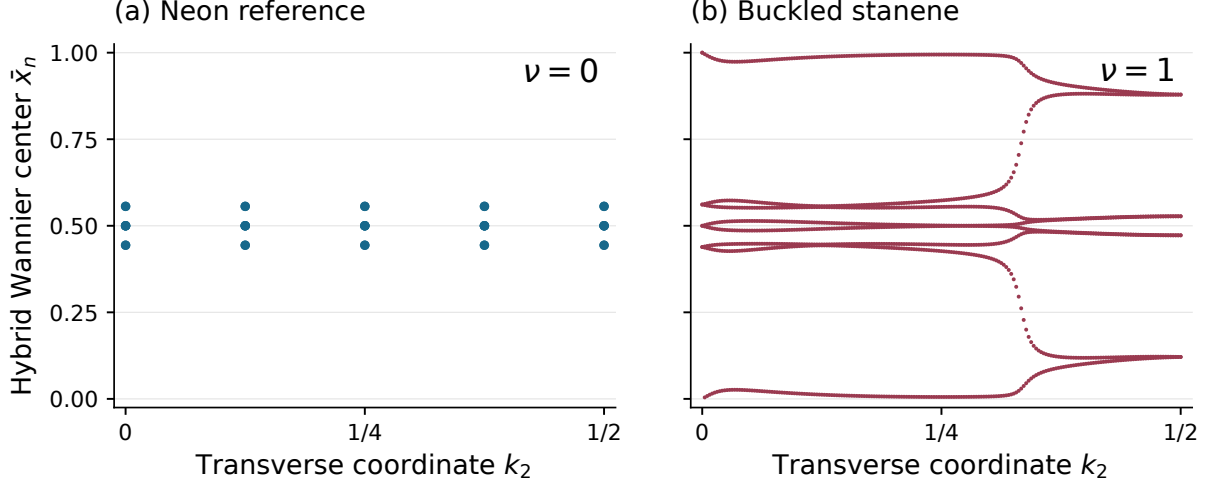


Figure 1: Wilson-loop test and demonstration calculations for (a) a periodic neon reference and (b) buckled stanene. Points are the computed hybrid Wannier centers in reduced units. Degenerate centers coincide. Each loop winds once along the first reciprocal coordinate, while the transverse coordinate spans $0 \leq k_2 \leq 1/2$ at $k_3 = 0$. The neon and stanene surfaces contain five and 193 loops, respectively, and yield $\nu = 0$ and $\nu = 1$. All eight occupied spinor centers are shown.

or a Wannier fit. If $T_{\mathcal{I}}(\mathbf{k})$ is the coefficient-space action of inversion, including atom permutations, orbital parities and lattice phases, its representation in the selected subspace is

$$D_{\mathcal{I}}(\mathbf{k}) = C^\dagger(\mathbf{k})S(\mathbf{k})T_{\mathcal{I}}(\mathbf{k})C(\mathbf{k}). \quad (6.1)$$

The overlap metric distinguishes the coefficient transformation $T_{\mathcal{I}}$ from the covariant AO matrix of the inversion operator. Character decomposition gives even and odd multiplicities without assigning gauge-dependent labels to individual vectors within a mixed degenerate eigenspace. For spinful time-reversal symmetry, the number of odd occupied Kramers pairs yields the two-dimensional plane index or the three-dimensional strong and weak Fu–Kane indices [14], together with an inversion z_4 indicator in three dimensions. An exact integer comparison with the analytic inversion-subgroup elementary-band-representation (EBR) signatures also tests membership in their integer lattice and the existence of a nonnegative decomposition [15, 16]. The implementation uses inversion rather than a complete space-group EBR catalogue, and an atomic-compatible signature does not establish trivial topology. Metric, subspace, energy-commutator and time-reversal checks precede classification. Additional parity calculations recover $\nu = 0$ for neon and $\nu = 1$ for stanene. The separately versioned tests are described in the Supporting Information and leave the retained Wilson spectra unchanged.

6.2 Little groups, nonsymmorphic phases, and spin

The extension from inversion to general crystalline symmetry needs more than a list of point rotations. Write a space-group operation as $g = \{W_g|\tau_g\}$ in fractional direct coordinates, so that $x \mapsto W_g x + \tau_g$. For cell matrix A , the Cartesian operation is $R_g = AW_g A^{-1}$. Reciprocal fractional vectors transform with W_g^{-T} , not in general with W_g . An antiunitary operation $g\Theta$ additionally reverses $\mathbf{k}$.

At a fixed fractional $\mathbf{k}$, the little group contains operations mapping $\mathbf{k}$ to itself modulo a reciprocal vector. Choose one representative per coset modulo integer translations of the cell. Composition gives

$$W_{gh} = W_g W_h, \quad L(g, h) = \tau_g + W_g \tau_h - \tau_{gh} \in \mathbb{Z}^3. \quad (6.2)$$

For spinors, the $SU(2)$ lifts additionally give a sign $z(g, h)$. The matrices acting in a fixed Bloch subspace must satisfy

$$D_g {}^{a_g}D_h = \omega(g, h) D_{gh}, \quad \omega(g, h) = e^{-2\pi i \mathbf{k} \cdot L(g, h)} z(g, h), \quad (6.3)$$

where $a_g = 1$ denotes antiunitarity and ${}^1D_h = \overline{D_h}$. Physical $\Theta^2 = -1$ contributes to the spin factor. Associativity requires the twisted cocycle identity

$$\omega(g, h) \omega(gh, j) = {}^{a_g}\omega(h, j) \omega(g, hj). \quad (6.4)$$

This distinguishes screw/glide operations from a point-group approximation and double-valued representations from scalar ones [17, 18].

A conventional centered cell has distinct cosets with the same rotation and different translations. Collapsing them by rotation alone loses folded translation sectors. Conversely, character data calculated in that conventional quotient cannot be matched blindly to a primitive-cell EBR table. Both the cell transformation and representation convention must be recorded.

6.3 Metric sewing and degeneracies

Let T_g contain the atom/AO action, Bloch-image phases and spin action. The sewing matrix between selected frames is

$$B_g(\mathbf{k}) = C^\dagger(g\mathbf{k}) S(g\mathbf{k}) T_g(\mathbf{k}) {}^{a_g}C(\mathbf{k}). \quad (6.5)$$

For a closed selected subspace it is unitary and reconstructs the transformed frame. Metric normalization, closure, and energy compatibility must be checked before extracting characters. Degeneracy is not resolved by labelling individual eigenvectors: unitary rotations within a degenerate block are physically arbitrary.

For a unitary little group and a complete character table with the same factor system, multiplicities follow from

$$n_\alpha = \frac{1}{|G_{\mathbf{k}}|} \sum_{g \in G_{\mathbf{k}}} \overline{\chi_\alpha(g)} \chi(g). \quad (6.6)$$

The result must be a nonnegative integer, with consistent reconstructed character and total dimension. Antiunitary operations require corepresentation theory, not unmodified use of this character formula. Characters alone also do not determine the sewing of directed Wilson links between different $\mathbf{k}$ -points.

The native implementation constructs a complete projective character table for the supplied unitary little group, rather than importing standard-label tables. Actual GPW/GAPW Gaussian coefficient actions include the atom permutation, AO rotation, cell-image phase and, where requested, the post-SCF GTH spinor action. The selected band sewing matrices are checked against Eq. (6.3) before characters are decomposed. Failed covariance or noninteger multiplicities are rejected, not repaired by rotating eigenvectors or rounding a defective representation.

6.4 Antiunitary corepresentations

Let the little group be $M = H \cup aH$, where H is its unitary subgroup. An irreducible projective character χ_α of H has antiunitary partner

$$\chi_\alpha^a(h) = \frac{\omega(h, a)}{\omega(a, a^{-1}ha)} \overline{\chi_\alpha(a^{-1}ha)}. \quad (6.7)$$

The Wigner indicator is [19]

$$w_\alpha = \frac{1}{|H|} \sum_{b \in aH} \omega(b, b) \chi_\alpha(b^2) \in \{+1, -1, 0\}. \quad (6.8)$$

Type +1 retains one copy of the unitary irrep, type -1 requires two copies, and type 0 pairs two inequivalent partner irreps. The native implementation determines these types and their integer unitary restriction matrix. Odd type- -1 multiplicities or unequal type-0 partner counts invalidate a selected band space. Spin and nonsymmorphic phases enter the same factor system and cannot be tested separately after those phases have been discarded.

These signs are neither topological indices nor antiunitary eigenvalues. Type +1 does not exclude Kramers degeneracy: an already multidimensional spin irrep can contain the required doublet without additional doubling. At a generic centrosymmetric SOC point, in contrast, the identity-only unitary subgroup may be doubled by the combined inversion-time-reversal operation. No canonical antiunitary eigenvector basis is assigned. The electronic-structure path currently constructs the nonmagnetic grey extension of the spatial group. The underlying algebra also accepts supplied magnetic factor systems, but this is not a magnetic space-group search or self-consistent noncollinear SOC calculation.

6.5 Nonsymmorphic band compatibility on explicit segments

For a directed connection from $\mathbf{k}_a$ to $\mathbf{k}_b + \mathbf{G}$, define $\mathbf{d} = \mathbf{k}_b + \mathbf{G} - \mathbf{k}_a$. A segment symmetry must satisfy

$$\sigma_g W_g^T \mathbf{d} = \mathbf{d}, \quad \sigma_g = (-1)^{a_g}, \quad (6.9)$$

within the fractional-coordinate tolerance, not merely modulo a reciprocal vector. Intersection of the endpoint little groups is insufficient: ordinary time reversal can fix two TRIM endpoints without preserving any interior point of their connecting segment.

To compare representations at the endpoints, remove the continuously varying translational part using

$$\eta_g(\mathbf{k}) = e^{2\pi i \mathbf{k} \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}_g}, \quad \bar{\omega}(g, h) = \eta_g^{a_g} \eta_h \eta_{gh}^* \omega(g, h). \quad (6.10)$$

The conjugation for an antiunitary first factor is essential. Both endpoints must produce the same rephased factor on the segment subgroup. Its unitary projective characters provide a common basis for integer endpoint-to-line branching matrices B_a, B_b . With selected endpoint multiplicities m_a, m_b , compatibility requires

$$B_a m_a = B_b m_b. \quad (6.11)$$

The destination rephasing uses $\mathbf{k}_b + \mathbf{G}$, not just $\mathbf{k}_b$. For example, a screw eigenvalue branch may exchange with another after one reciprocal period. Ignoring $\mathbf{G}$ would erase this monodromy. Integer changes of coset representatives cancel between the characters and the rephasing.

Endpoint corepresentations are restricted as whole representations. If R_a and R_ℓ give the unitary restrictions of endpoint and line corepresentations, their branching C_a satisfies

$$R_\ell C_a = B_a R_a. \quad (6.12)$$

If the line has no antiunitary stabilizer, $B_a R_a$ instead describes the branching into unitary line irreps. This retains endpoint partner constraints even when time reversal is absent on the interior. A spinful glide model illustrates the distinction: opposite glide partners at Gamma become same-branch pairs at the boundary, preventing an isolated two-band connection but allowing a four-band one. For valid corepresentations, unitary and corepresentation line-count compatibility are equivalent; the latter resolves the partner structure rather than introducing a new invariant.

These operations are implemented on explicit NNKP or generated Wilson links through `LITTLE_GROUP_COMPATIBILITY`, which implies `LITTLE_GROUP_IRREPS`. Compatible endpoints do not prove a gap between sampled points, a trivial Bloch bundle, or an atomic-band decomposition. Automatic complete Brillouin-zone connectivity and standard crystallographic irrep labels remain separate work.

6.6 Site-induced atomic band representations

The native induction kernel starts from a supplied fractional site q and constructs its orbit $q_j = t_j q$ modulo integer translations. Representatives t_j are adjusted by lattice translations to reach the chosen positions exactly. Localized orbitals carry irreps of the site stabilizer; an antiunitary stabilizer instead requires the complete corepresentations described above. Their unitary restriction characters are denoted by χ_α .

For a unitary little-group operation g that fixes site j modulo translations, set

$$L_{gj} = W_g q_j + \tau_g - q_j \in \mathbb{Z}^3, \quad h_j = t_j^{-1} \{I - L_{gj}\} g t_j. \quad (6.13)$$

The induced character is

$$\chi_\alpha^\uparrow(g; \mathbf{k}) = \sum_{j: gq_j = q_j \bmod \mathbb{Z}^3} e^{-2\pi i \mathbf{k} \cdot L_{gj}} \frac{z(g, t_j)}{z(t_j, h_j)} a_{t_j} \chi_\alpha(h_j). \quad (6.14)$$

This is the Bloch form of site induction [33], with the spin factor in the same convention as Eq. (6.3). Antiunitary orbit representatives conjugate the onsite character even though g itself is unitary. Omitting this conjugation loses complex orbital partners.

The implementation retains conventional-cell centering cosets and keeps each local representation column fixed across $\mathbf{k}$ points. Its band rank is the orbit multiplicity times the local dimension. No full band diagonalization or orbital gauge choice is needed to generate these atomic reference characters. Validation compares their little-group decompositions and segment restrictions with independent Cartesian s/p/d orbital and spin traces. Site induction alone neither enumerates all Wyckoff positions nor establishes that an induced representation is elementary.

6.7 Band representations and limits of indicators

Elementary band representations (EBRs) provide the indecomposable building blocks of atomic band representations. Restricting them to little groups yields a vector of irrep multiplicities. Compatibility relations constrain the vectors that can connect along high-symmetry lines. A candidate symmetry vector n can be compared with an integer matrix of EBR signatures,

$$Eq = n. \quad (6.15)$$

Integer solvability, nonnegative solvability, and compatibility constraints are different questions. A symmetry indicator is a quotient of compatible representation data by atomic data; it can miss topology invisible to those symmetry eigenvalues [15, 16]. An atomic-compatible signature is not proof of a trivial Bloch bundle. A signed-only decomposition is not, without additional information, a complete diagnosis of fragile topology.

The implemented EBR-signature classifier still uses the inversion subgroup and its analytic atomic signatures. The general native little-group/corepresentation, explicit-segment and site-induction machinery supplies additional representation data, not a complete all-space-group classification. Conventional-to-primitive matching, standard labels, complete connectivity and a validated catalogue with elementarity checks are still required. Algebra tests over all ordinary space groups must not be presented as a completed classification of all their materials.

7 Parameter-space topology and phasons

A separate native postprocessor, `topology_phasons`, extends the overlap construction to closed two- or four-parameter families, including periodic atomic displacements (phasons) combined with reciprocal coordinates. It reads `STATE_EXPORT` snapshots and evaluates $M_{ab} = C_a^\dagger O_{ab} C_b$, where O_{ab} includes the Gaussian centers of both geometries, periodic images, and Bloch and boundary-sewing phases. Polar-unitary links give C_1 from determinant plaquette phases [20] and

a four-parameter C_2 estimate from full non-Abelian plaquette logarithms [21]. Here C_2 denotes the second Chern character pairing, not generally the second Chern class. The postprocessor requires neither Python, Z2Pack, nor Wannier90 at runtime. It operates on fixed-cell, fixed-rank families with explicit physical endpoint identifications. The Supporting Information gives its separate development version, discretization, and model and Gaussian-snapshot tests. These tests complement the material examples below without changing their Hamiltonians, sampling, or results.

For a discrete parameter family, let $Q_\mu(x)$ denote the polar link from x to $x + \hat{\mu}$. An oriented plaquette is

$$P_{\mu\nu}(x) = Q_\mu(x)Q_\nu(x + \hat{\mu})Q_\mu^\dagger(x + \hat{\nu})Q_\nu^\dagger(x). \quad (7.1)$$

With the implemented directed-overlap convention, $C_1^{\text{mesh}} = -(2\pi)^{-1} \sum_x \arg \det P_{12}(x)$. For four parameters write $F_{\mu\nu}(x) = \log P_{\mu\nu}(x)$ using the principal matrix logarithm. The non-Abelian estimator is

$$C_2^{\text{mesh}} = -\frac{1}{4\pi^2} \sum_x \Re \text{Tr}[F_{12}F_{34} - F_{13}F_{24} + F_{14}F_{23}](x). \quad (7.2)$$

The logarithms already include the discrete plaquette area. Mesh refinement, physical endpoint identifications, and a fixed isolated rank are essential. Coefficient arrays from different geometries cannot be contracted without cross-geometry AO overlaps. The numerical value is retained before rounding, and a sampled gap does not certify isolation between sampled geometries.

8 Spectral localizers in finite and periodic systems

8.1 Energy-position tuples and Clifford structure

A spectral localizer combines operators associated with several observables into one self-adjoint matrix. For two positions and a Hamiltonian, Pauli matrices provide a Clifford representation. In an orthonormal space define

$$\tilde{L} = (\tilde{H} - EI) \otimes \sigma_z + \kappa(\tilde{X} - xI) \otimes \sigma_x + \kappa(\tilde{Y} - yI) \otimes \sigma_y, \quad (8.1)$$

up to the explicitly fixed tensor ordering. The parameter $\kappa > 0$ has units of energy/length. It balances energy and position resolution rather than correcting the Hamiltonian. The connection between a localizer signature and an even index pairing holds under appropriate locality, gap, and finite-volume bounds [22]. Those hypotheses remain relevant when interpreting a finite Gaussian model.

In auxiliary-index-first ordering the covariant AO matrix is

$$L = \begin{pmatrix} H - ES & \kappa[(X - xS) - i(Y - yS)] \\ \kappa[(X - xS) + i(Y - yS)] & -(H - ES) \end{pmatrix}, \quad B = \begin{pmatrix} S & 0 \\ 0 & S \end{pmatrix}. \quad (8.2)$$

For SOC, H and S here denote the physical spinor matrices. Auxiliary doubling is separate from spin, so the localizer dimension is four times the scalar AO count. All AO directions are retained: there is no hidden occupied-space projection or automatic removal of nearly dependent basis functions.

8.2 Index, metric gap, and stability

For class A define

$$\nu_A = \frac{1}{2} \text{Sig}(L) = \frac{1}{2}(n_+ - n_-), \quad \mu = \min_j |\lambda_j|, \quad Lv_j = \lambda_j Bv_j. \quad (8.3)$$

Signature is invariant under nonsingular congruence, whereas ordinary eigenvalues of a covariant AO matrix are not. Inertia can therefore be evaluated directly from L , but the protection gap

must retain B . Equivalently, μ is the smallest absolute eigenvalue of $B^{-1/2}LB^{-1/2}$; this identity does not require forming that dense matrix.

At fixed metric, the index cannot change under a perturbation satisfying

$$\|B^{-1/2}\delta LB^{-1/2}\| < \mu. \quad (8.4)$$

This finite-matrix statement gives local protection an operational meaning. If the metric changes, the corresponding orthonormalized problems must be compared, including the effect of δB . An unresolved near-zero gap yields an *unresolved* index, not evidence for trivial topology.

Moving the query and coordinate operators together, shifting the Hamiltonian and query energy together, or changing AO basis must leave the generalized gap unchanged. Reversing the oriented plane reverses the class A sign. Model comparisons establish the sign convention before applying it to a material.

8.3 Inertia and gap require different calculations

A pivoted Hermitian factorization has the form

$$P^\dagger LP = \mathcal{L} D \mathcal{L}^\dagger. \quad (8.5)$$

Here $\mathcal{L}$ is unit lower triangular and D contains 1×1 and 2×2 blocks. Sylvester's law transfers the inertia from L to D . For a Hermitian block,

$$D_b = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ \bar{b} & d \end{pmatrix}, \quad \lambda_{\pm} = \frac{a+d}{2} \pm \sqrt{\left(\frac{a-d}{2}\right)^2 + |b|^2}.$$

Stable evaluation must retain scaling and both signs. A zero-diagonal block with $b \neq 0$ has one positive and one negative direction; counting its diagonal entries is wrong. The dense reference uses LAPACK ZHETRF, with DSYTRF for exactly real matrices [23]. A small imaginary part is not discarded to select real arithmetic.

Pivot magnitudes are not generalized gaps. For $\sigma > 0$, shifted inertia counts satisfy, away from singular endpoints,

$$\begin{aligned} n_-(L - \sigma B) - n_-(L) &= \#\{j : 0 < \lambda_j < \sigma\}, \\ n_-(L) - n_-(L + \sigma B) &= \#\{j : -\sigma < \lambda_j < 0\}. \end{aligned} \quad (8.6)$$

These counts bracket the nearest positive or negative generalized eigenvalue. Factorization failure or an ambiguous endpoint must not be treated as a successful certificate. The reported bounds are finite-precision numerical brackets, not interval-arithmetic guarantees.

8.4 Pfaffian orientation and physical time reversal

For a real skew-symmetric matrix A of even order, $\det A = \text{Pf}(A)^2$: the determinant loses the Pfaffian sign. Moreover, $\text{Pf}(P^T A P) = \det(P) \text{Pf}(A)$. An odd simultaneous row/column permutation reverses that sign without changing the determinant. Ordinary inertia cannot replace a skew factorization with explicit permutation bookkeeping.

For spinful time reversal with $\Theta^2 = -1$, the localizer has a real skew representation [24, 25]. In auxiliary/spin/AO ordering, let $C = J_{\text{aux}} \otimes J$ and $Q = (I - iC)/\sqrt{2}$. The symmetry relations imply that

$$A = iQ^\dagger L Q \quad (8.7)$$

is real and skew-symmetric. Both properties are checked numerically, with residuals small relative to the independently resolved metric gap. An arbitrary complex AO basis change also transforms time reversal; keeping J fixed would generally be inconsistent.

Let A_0 be the corresponding transform of $L_0 = \text{diag}(S, -S)$. The reference-calibrated index is

$$(-1)^{\nu_{\text{AII}}} = \text{sgn Pf}(A) \text{sgn Pf}(A_0). \quad (8.8)$$

Both factors use the same ordering and orientation. The dense algorithm accumulates signs rather than an overflowing Pfaffian product. This is a time-reversal local index, not an inversion-parity test.

The optional sparse skew-LDL backend implements a separate numerical task from MUMPS inertia [25]. Its present single-rank factorization must not be described as an MPI-distributed Pfaffian solver. The motivating photonic and aperiodic examples [9, 25] provide methodological context, not first-principles material validation for the CP2K path.

8.5 Periodic positions and the torus construction

A Cartesian coordinate truncated to a primitive cell is discontinuous at the periodic seam. Using it in the open-boundary localizer is not a periodic formulation. Instead, analytic periodic functions are used [26]. For analysis-torus reciprocal vectors $\mathbf{G}_j$ and $\phi_j = \mathbf{G}_j \cdot \mathbf{r}_0$, define

$$\begin{aligned} C_j &= \langle \phi_\mu | \cos(\mathbf{G}_j \cdot \mathbf{r} - \phi_j) | \phi_\nu \rangle, \\ T_j &= \langle \phi_\mu | \sin(\mathbf{G}_j \cdot \mathbf{r} - \phi_j) | \phi_\nu \rangle. \end{aligned} \quad (8.9)$$

In the implemented orientation,

$$L_{\text{per}} = \begin{pmatrix} H - ES - \eta(2S - C_1 - C_2) & \eta(T_1 - iT_2) \\ \eta(T_1 + iT_2) & -H + ES + \eta(2S - C_1 - C_2) \end{pmatrix}. \quad (8.10)$$

The energy scale η is distinct from κ , and the metric remains $\text{diag}(S, S)$. An overall sign and auxiliary-space conjugation relative to the cited periodic construction make its orientation consistent with the finite localizer used here.

The trigonometric operators are integrated directly, not evaluated as matrix functions of finite projected Cartesian positions. Projection need not preserve either exact unitarity of exponentials or their commutativity. The theorem for a gapped finite-range lattice Hamiltonian therefore does not automatically become a theorem for an arbitrary Gaussian projection. The output is an AO-torus diagnostic requiring independent basis-, torus-, and scale-converged material checks.

Explicit analysis k-points describe the enlarged torus through its complete mesh. Periodic exponentials shift between mesh sectors, so their cross-k links must be retained. A symmetry-reduced SCF can supply the potential, but scalar SCF weights cannot replace the full torus operator. The present periodic localizer covers two-dimensional periodic planes; a general three-dimensional AII implementation is not claimed.

8.6 Connection to the quadratic pseudospectrum

For Hermitian operators A_j and anticommuting Hermitian Clifford matrices γ_j , squaring $L = \sum_j A_j \otimes \gamma_j$ gives

$$L^2 = \left(\sum_j A_j^2 \right) \otimes I + \sum_{j < l} [A_j, A_l] \otimes \gamma_j \gamma_l. \quad (8.11)$$

The first term measures simultaneous approximate localization; the second retains noncommutativity. The quadratic gap and localizer gap are related, but not interchangeable. In an AO basis each projected product must include the metric, or be evaluated after orthonormalization.

9 Quadratic pseudospectrum and localized approximate states

The quadratic pseudospectrum asks for a normalized state that minimizes the combined residual of incompatible observables [27]. For a query $(E, \mathbf{x})$, set $A_0 = H - ES$, $A_j = X_j - x_j S$, $w_0 = 1$, and $w_j = \kappa$ for $j = 1, 2, 3$. The AO problem is

$$Qc = \lambda Sc, \quad Q = \sum_{j=0}^3 w_j^2 A_j^\dagger S^{-1} A_j, \quad c^\dagger Sc = 1. \quad (9.1)$$

The minimum $\sqrt{\lambda}$ is the quadratic gap. Its eigenvector is a joint approximate state, and several low eigenpairs can describe a localized subspace. The separated residuals are

$$\begin{aligned} \delta E^2 &= (A_0 c)^\dagger S^{-1} (A_0 c), \\ \delta x_j^2 &= (A_j c)^\dagger S^{-1} (A_j c), \\ \lambda &= \delta E^2 + \kappa^2 \sum_j \delta x_j^2. \end{aligned} \quad (9.2)$$

Expectations $c^\dagger H c$ and $c^\dagger X_j c$ distinguish bias from spread around the query. These states need not be eigenstates of H . Within degenerate minimizing spaces, projectors or subspace observables must be compared instead of individual coefficients.

Equation (9.1) is positive semidefinite and covariant under Eq. (2.3). Ordinary matrix products without metric solutions would destroy that invariance. The position residual concerns the projected position: $X_j S^{-1} X_j$ is not an independently integrated continuum $\langle r_j^2 \rangle$. Small bases can underestimate continuum localization errors even when the eigenproblem is solved accurately.

The dense reference uses a complete orthonormalized space. The iterative path applies Q without forming it: multiply by A_j , solve with S , multiply by $A_j^\dagger$, and accumulate. This avoids fill-in from explicitly squaring sparse matrices. A complex block Rayleigh–Ritz iteration, double metric reorthogonalization, and thick restarts address clustered low states. The residual

$$\|Qc - \lambda Sc\|_{S^{-1}} \leq \epsilon_{\text{eig}} \max(1, |\lambda|)$$

checks an eigenpair in atomic units; it does not independently prove that no lower state was missed.

Reusable MUMPS factors avoid forming S^{-1} , but the present trial vectors and multiple-right-hand-side communication are not fully distributed. Output includes separated residuals, expectations, and optional complex AO coefficients. The current analysis covers isolated GPW/GAPW systems and post-SCF GTH SOC. Periodic quadratic formulations and band unfolding remain separate extensions. A small quadratic gap is a localization diagnostic, not a Chern or $\mathbb{Z}_2$ index.

10 Materials-discovery applications and demonstrative tests

10.1 Hybrid-functional topological materials databases

TopoHSE-DB provides an application example of electronic-structure-based topological classification at database scale [28]. Mirhosseini, Elcoro, Knüpfner and Kühne combine consistently relaxed nonmagnetic crystal structures, PBE and screened-hybrid HSE06 electronic structures, and topological quantum chemistry. Comparing the resulting labels exposes the sensitivity of a symmetry-based classification to the underlying exchange–correlation approximation. A converged integer or symmetry label is therefore not, by itself, evidence that the electronic Hamiltonian has been described accurately.

The original database workflow uses VASP, VASP2Trace, and CheckTopologicalMat. It is cited here as a materials-discovery application and a source of future comparison cases, not as a calculation performed with the new CP2K topology routines. Connecting such a workflow to

CP2K requires equivalent electronic structure and symmetry conventions as well as the general little-group, compatibility-relation, and EBR machinery discussed in Section 6. The currently implemented inversion analysis does not yet reproduce the database’s full classification workflow.

10.2 Generative–predictive discovery of candidate materials

The submitted study by Brocai, Kühne, Knüpfer and Mirhosseini, *Generative–predictive models enable the discovery of topological materials*, provides a complementary application [29]. It couples topology-conditioned crystal generation to a predictive filter using a shared pretrained representation, followed by hybrid-functional electronic-structure and TQC analysis. The submitted manuscript reports 1,033 successfully calculated hybrid-functional band structures; 629 receive an unambiguous classification and 523 are classified as topological. The corresponding 83.15% rate applies to the classified subset, whereas the confirmed yield across all 1,033 calculated cases is 50.6%. The 404 unresolved classifications must not be silently counted as either trivial or topological.

These results, obtained with the study’s VASP-based workflow, illustrate the demand for reliable post-processing and explicit failure diagnostics. They also motivate subsequent, distinct questions: Wilson spectra can probe isolated band subspaces, Kubo calculations can address transport at specified temperature and dissipation, and localizers can investigate finite, defective, or disordered realizations of selected candidates. These are prospective CP2K follow-up applications, not calculations already completed for the reported candidate set. A TQC label alone does not supply a conductivity or a localizer protection gap.

10.3 Small calculations as tests and demonstrations

The smaller calculations in this paper and the companion k-point study serve a different purpose [30]. They provide transparent tests and demonstrations of individual algorithmic steps, not a second materials-discovery survey. Table 1 states the role of each set.

Calculation set	Demonstration and test objective
Si and Al, companion k-point study	Quadrature dependence and equivalent full-grid, time-reversal, K290, and SPGLIB representations. At fixed 4^3 sampling, 64 eigensystems reduce to four with atomic symmetry.
Periodic neon and buckled stanene	Trivial and nontrivial Wilson-loop examples, with $\nu = 0$ and $\nu = 1$, respectively; comparison of native and external analyses.
Ne/SOC, Bi ₂ /SOC, and diamond/SOC	Primitive-mesh versus supercell and reduced versus full-property-grid checks of the metric, Hamiltonian, and current operators.
Analytic localizer models and small GPW/GAPW systems	Known indices, gap closings, basis covariance, and dense/sparse solver consistency; quadratic-state residual and subspace checks.

Table 1: Test and demonstration calculations, distinct from the materials-discovery applications cited above. The Si/Al results are retained from the companion study, not rerun or reassigned to the new topology implementation.

For Si and Al, the largest fixed-mesh cell-energy or electronic-free-energy difference among the compared representations is 1.4×10^{-12} hartree. This tests representation equivalence, not complete basis or k-point convergence. In particular, the Al free energy still changes by 10.721 meV per atom between the 6^3 and 8^3 meshes. Likewise, agreement between Wilson analyses using the same overlap matrices tests the analysis stage, while independent operator identities test the AO construction. The quantitative checks in Section 11 and the Supporting Information retain these distinctions and their original calculation provenance.

11 Implementation, validation, and development boundaries

11.1 Shared operators and optional numerical backends

The finite-system property paths share full AO Hamiltonians, overlap, analytic positions, and optional GTH-SOC blocks. DBCSR supplies distributed block storage and matrix products [31]. Localizer assembly retains the union of the operator sparsity patterns without additional dropping. DBCSR is not itself a general pivoted indefinite factorization or Pfaffian solver.

The dense LAPACK path is the small-system reference. MUMPS supplies distributed symmetric-indefinite factorizations and reusable metric solutions [32]. Complex Hermitian matrices are realified:

$$\mathcal{R}(A) = \begin{pmatrix} \Re A & -\Im A \\ \Im A & \Re A \end{pmatrix}. \quad (11.1)$$

Each eigenvalue is duplicated, so inertia-based formulas compensate for that duplication. A positive metric is checked separately from the indefinite localizer. Static pivot perturbations and low-rank compression are not silently accepted as exact sign counts. Symbolic analysis is reused across appropriate shift families.

The optional Tacho skew-LDL extension is accessed through a small C interface and Fortran interoperability [34]. No MATLAB dependency is introduced. Permutation parity, skew-pivot conventions, numerical residuals, and the trivial-reference orientation are explicit. Its sparse factorization currently resides on one rank, while DBCSR assembly and MUMPS metric/gap checks can be distributed. PARDISO and PEXSI are possible alternative backends, not prerequisites and not part of the tested backend set reported here.

MUMPS factor storage and process-summed solver memory are not the whole application’s memory consumption. Sparse fill-in, source-rank coordinates, dense reference arrays, trial vectors, and MPI buffers must be accounted for separately. Similarly, single-node timings cannot establish multi-node scaling.

11.2 Three levels of validation

The first level tests algebra independently of an SCF calculation: metric congruences, origins, energy shifts, degeneracies, time reversal, permutation orientation, and analytic model indices. The second compares numerical algorithms on identical matrices: dense eigenvalues against LDL inertia, dense against sparse gap brackets, dense against skew-LDL signs, and full against iterative quadratic eigenproblems. The third exercises operator construction from actual converged CP2K GPW/GAPW calculations.

Retained checks include open and periodic Chern models, spin-mixed time-reversed model pairs, gap closings, singular and indefinite metrics, and deliberately broken symmetry. They establish nontrivial topology in controlled models. Small molecular and bulk integration fixtures instead establish that the AO data reach the algorithms consistently; most are not nontrivial first-principles topological materials.

The retained neon and stanene Wilson results in Section 5 are small band-topology test and demonstration calculations, with matching inversion indices. They complement the Si/Al k-point demonstrations summarized in Section 10, rather than constituting a materials-discovery application study. They were produced with their recorded executable and sampling. They are not relabelled as localizer or Kubo calculations merely because the underlying operators are now shared.

11.3 Quantitative test and demonstration calculations

Table 2 records representative comparisons from the retained development runs. Agreement is measured between calculations at identical numerical settings unless noted otherwise. These are consistency checks, not a claim of basis- and material-converged conductivity.

Comparison	Retained result and meaning
Ne/SOC primitive mesh versus Gamma supercell	A $3 \times 1 \times 2$ primitive mesh and its explicit Gamma supercell give $6.21105320 \times 10^{-9}$ S at the converged comparison settings.
Bi ₂ /SOC property symmetry	Six of 27 eigensystems suffice; the maximum printed full-tensor relative difference from the unreduced calculation is 2.71×10^{-15} .
Primitive diamond/SOC	Both K290 and SPGLIB use three of eight representatives; the full-tensor relative difference is 2.21×10^{-11} .
Bi ₂ quadratic states	Dense and iterative gaps agree within 6×10^{-15} hartree; four metric-subspace singular values differ from unity by less than 10^{-10} .

Table 2: Operator-level checks retained on 24 September 2026. Raw settings and limitations are recorded in the Supporting Information. The transport numbers are numerical fixtures, not material predictions.

For the diamond property reconstruction, metric, Hamiltonian, and current residuals are checked separately rather than inferred from the final scalar conductivity. Degenerate subspaces retain their transformed gauge. The representative count measures avoided diagonalizations, not total speedup.

The crystalline representation tests cover all 530 Hall settings of the 230 ordinary space groups, scalar and spinful factors, and their grey extensions. They validate 6,360 unitary projective character tables, 5,324 antiunitary corepresentation tables, and 12,720 directed segment comparisons; 4,462 segments retain antiunitary symmetry. Release and bounds-checked debug runs agree. The Gaussian little-group directory passes 47 numerical assertions in both serial and two-rank MPI runs, including GPW, GAPW, post-SCF SOC, screw monodromy and refined Wilson links. These counts describe algebra and small integration tests, not 230 separate converged material studies. The Supporting Information separates this evidence from a supplied magnetic-group algebra sweep and its independent reference comparison.

The site-induction kernel adds 38,160 site/k-point cases over the same Hall settings, using three positions per cell. Their 67,824 induced local-representation columns have valid little-group decompositions and satisfy the checked directed compatibility relations. Independent Cartesian s/p/d orbital traces, with and without physical spin, give 114,480 matching character comparisons. This tests atomic reference construction rather than a Wyckoff catalogue or an EBR classification of first-principles bands.

11.4 Convergence and material validation

Before submission, the material set should include matched crystalline band and real-space indices, finite-size SOC flakes, disordered configurations, and controlled transitions. Transport studies need independent convergence of basis, mesh or size, temperature, and dissipation. Localizer studies need a stable scale interval and a spatial map of both the index and its protection gap. The paper should report failed or unresolved parameter regions rather than select only points with the desired integer.

12 Conclusions

A common nonorthogonal operator representation connects several otherwise distinct ways of analysing electronic states in CP2K. Metric-aware current operators support finite-temperature transport; directed Gaussian overlaps support Wilson and parameter-space invariants; and Hamiltonian-position tuples support local indices and joint approximate states. Sparse assembly

and factorization address their numerical cost without replacing the physical assumptions of each construction.

The present evidence establishes operator and solver consistency for the tested models and small GPW/GAPW/SOC calculations, alongside the retained neon and stanene band-topology demonstrations and the Si/Al k-point tests of the companion study. The TopoHSE-DB and generative–predictive discovery studies illustrate the materials-science applications motivating this infrastructure; their published or submitted results are not new CP2K validation data. The present tests do not establish all-space-group TQC, a general Hall-response implementation, or size-converged first-principles localizer classifications. Those boundaries are part of the method specification.

The crystalline framework now resolves projective unitary irreps, antiunitary pairing and doubling, and their restrictions along explicit reciprocal-space segments. Its algebraic coverage across conventional cell settings and supplied magnetic groups is distinct from a magnetic electronic-structure implementation or a complete EBR catalogue. The next material studies must converge the electronic structure, geometry or torus size, analysis sampling, and numerical scales independently, rather than interpreting a stable integer from a single small matrix as a bulk-material result.

Code and Data Availability

The manuscript sources, Supporting Information, and retained validation records are maintained in the development repository <https://github.com/DCM-Uni-Paderborn/TopologicalCP2K>. The repository currently has restricted access during manuscript preparation; public archival availability will be established before publication. CP2K is distributed under the GNU General Public License, version 2 or later, at <https://github.com/cp2k/cp2k>. The working implementation and retained calculation records are described in the Supporting Information. Not all developments described here are present in an upstream release. A final reproducible source snapshot, external-library versions, and public data archive must accompany submission. The present draft does not assign an archival DOI or imply that the development branch has already been released.

Authorship and Declarations

The author list and corresponding author follow the agreed manuscript scope. Affiliations, CRediT roles, funding, competing-interest declarations, and any required disclosure concerning writing tools are to be confirmed by all authors before submission.

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